

IN CONTEXT

The Risorgimento

The 19th-century movement called the Risorgimento (“resurgence”) turned Italy into a united nation state. In 1815, the Italian peninsula was politically fragmented, with different areas ruled by Austria, the pope, and various monarchs. Popular uprisings in 1848–1849 seeking to create an Italian republic failed. After a series of wars, including the invasion of Sicily and the south by the followers of Giuseppe Garibaldi in 1860–1861, the whole of Italy was united in 1870 under King Victor Emmanuel II. As Italy’s leading composer, Verdi acted as a focus for nationalist sentiment throughout the Risorgimento.



GIUSEPPE GARIBALDI IS WELCOMED IN
VICENZA ON MARCH 7, 1867

The son of an innkeeper, Giuseppe Verdi was born in 1813 in the